

HAND AND POWER TOOLS TOOLBOX TALK

Control cutting, crushing, electric-shock and flying-particle hazards.

8-10 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Review cutting, crushing, entanglement, electric-shock, accessory failure and flying-particle hazards during the selection, inspection and use of hand and power tools, and verify equipment, guarding and PPE controls before work begins.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Every tool must be used only for its intended purpose. Using a screwdriver as a chisel, a wrench as a hammer or an unsuitable disc on a grinder can lead to loss of control and equipment failure.
- Power tools must be inspected before use, including cables, plugs, housings, triggers, guards and accessories. Damaged equipment must be removed from service, tagged and quarantined.
- Power must be isolated before changing discs, bits or accessories. Guards must not be removed, and accessory size and maximum speed must be compatible with the tool.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A worker fitted an oversized grinding disc with an insufficient speed rating. The guard had also been removed to make the task easier.
- The disc shattered during operation, sending high-speed fragments toward the worker and another person nearby.
- The incident could have been prevented through correct disc selection, speed verification, use of the guard, face protection and a pre-use inspection.

REMEMBER

Do not use damaged, unguarded equipment or tools fitted with unsuitable accessories. Stop work and quarantine the tool.

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Hazards, correct use and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- Damaged cables, plugs, housings or triggers.
- Removed or modified guards.
- Incorrect discs, bits or accessories.
- Accessory speed rating lower than tool speed.
- Cuts, crushing, entanglement and kickback.
- Electric shock and short circuits.
- Flying particles, sparks and dust exposure.
- Cables and hoses creating trip or damage hazards.

CONTROL MEASURES

- Inspect the tool and accessories before use.
- Use only approved equipment suitable for the task.
- Keep guards fitted and functional.
- Verify disc size and maximum speed compatibility.
- Isolate power before changing accessories.
- Secure the workpiece and maintain a stable position.
- Route cables and hoses safely.
- Use suitable eye, face, hand and hearing protection.
- Quarantine and report damaged equipment.
- Do not complete unauthorised repairs or modifications.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Team, before starting today, we will inspect every hand tool and power tool. We will not use equipment with damaged cables, missing guards or unsuitable accessories. Power will be isolated before changing discs or bits. We will secure the workpiece, use the correct PPE and quarantine damaged tools immediately.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Have the tools and accessories been inspected?
- Are all guards fitted and functional?
- Is the disc or bit compatible with the tool?
- Will power be isolated before changing accessories?
- Are cables and hoses routed safely?
- What action will be taken if damaged equipment is found?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Tool intact | ☐ Cable and plug intact |
| ☐ Guard fitted | ☐ Accessory suitable |
| ☐ Speed compatibility verified | ☐ Workpiece secured |
| ☐ Cable route safe | ☐ PPE suitable |
| ☐ Area controlled | ☐ Damaged tools removed |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

HAND AND POWER TOOLS TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
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Supervisor notes / additional site instructions